School Words

Teacher Guide · Topic 10 of 12 · Value: Respectful





At a glance	
Goal	Students learn what to say, and how, when someone cuts in line, takes their things, or teases them: stand tall and look, use a strong, calm voice, say the child's name and "please" plus what they need. For teasing, there is no please: "Stop. That's not kind." If it keeps happening, they get a grown-up. Mad is okay; mean words are not.
Time	15 minutes in Morning Meeting, in place of the general lesson. Centers run during the week.
When	Teach after Topic 9, Things Stay Safe. Teach it on a calm day, never the morning after a student was teased or said something hurtful.
In the bundle	Student deck (7 slides, press N for notes) · Poster (letter and 11×17) · Center kit (sort, sequence, act it out, desk strips, coloring) · Mini book · Family half-sheet
Words we use	"Diego, I was here first. Please go behind me." · "Kiara, that's my marker. Please give it back." · "Malik, stop. That's not kind." (no please for teasing) · "Strong, not loud."

Before you teach

- Post the three school-word sentences at child height: Please go behind me. Please give it back. Stop. That's not kind.
- Practice the three voices yourself (whisper, booming, strong and calm) so the contrast on slide 5 is clear.
- Hang the poster near the classroom door or line-up spot, where cutting and teasing happen most.
- Plan to play the friend who cuts, takes, or teases. Students only ever practice the response.
- Tape a desk strip at the table of any student who yells, calls names, or grabs back.
- Pair students who need support with a steady turn-and-talk partner before the lesson starts.

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The lesson, slide by slide

The same script is in the deck's presenter notes. Press N while presenting.

Slide	Say and do	Look for	Engagement move
1 · Title & Promise (R2)	Stand tall. "Today we learn what to say, and how to say it." Say together: "Strong, kind school words!"	Students repeat the line in a strong, calm voice.	Equity stick: "Show me your strong, tall body."
2 · Get Calm First (R1)	Do it with them. "Smell the flower. Blow out the candle. Long and slow. Three times."	Exhale longer than inhale; shoulders drop.	LiveSchool point: "You breathed slow three times."
3 · What Did Tee Say? (R2, R3)	Point to each picture. "Diego cut in line. Tee felt mad. He took a breath, stood tall, looked at Diego, and said, 'Diego, I was here first. Please go behind me.' Diego said, 'Oh, sorry!'" Class says: "Stand tall. Strong voice. Say their name and please."	Students follow the pictures; whole class repeats the line.	Equity stick: "What did Tee say first?"
4 · Turn and Talk (R3, R4)	"Kiara took Lee's marker. Tell your partner what Lee can say: Kiara, please ___." 30 seconds, then two shares and say it together.	Every sentence has the name and please.	Equity stick: two shares.
5 · Watch Me, Then Show Me (R3, R4, R5)	Model the three voices: too quiet, too loud, strong and calm. Play the friend who cuts; a student stands tall and says the words. Then play the friend who keeps laughing; the student says, "Stop. That's not kind," then gets you, the grown-up.	Tall body; strong, not loud; name first, then please (or a firm "stop" for teasing); gets a grown-up when it keeps happening.	LiveSchool point for the student model.
6 · My Promise Today (R2, R5)	Hand on heart. "Say it with me: I use strong, kind school words." Then: "Point to one thing you can do."	Every student says the promise and points to one picture.	Equity stick: three names. Pointing counts.
7 · How We Leave (R1, R4, R5)	"Stand tall. Quiet lips. Walk. Ready to learn." Do not time this at K–2.	Tall, calm bodies; quiet lips while moving.	LiveSchool point for a student you hear using a strong, kind school word.

Practice bridges for slide 5

Students model, not the teacher. The teacher narrates and asks the class what they saw.

If the model is...	Say
Excellent	"Show us again. Everyone, listen: strong, not loud."
Partly right	"Your words were kind. Now stand tall and look at me. Try again."

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If the model is...	Say
Silly	“Thank you. Let’s hear it with school words.” Call a new student. No commentary.

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Centers

Print one kit per group. Laminate the mats and cards so they last. Students work in groups of 2 to 4.

Center	Set up	Read to students	Done looks like
Sort It	Sort mat (landscape page) and 8 cut picture cards.	"Look at each picture. Is this friend using school words? Put it on the side where it goes."	4 cards on School words, 4 on Not school words. Accept any sort a student can explain.
Put It in Order	Sequencing mat and 4 cut cards.	"Put Tee's story in order: first, next, then, last. Tell your partner the story."	Students retell: Diego cuts, Tee stands tall, Tee says please go behind me, Diego says sorry.
Act It Out	4 role-play cards in a stack. The adult or a partner plays the friend; the student only says the school words.	"Pick a card. Read it with me. Stand tall and say it strong and kind."	Each student stands tall, says the friend's name and the please sentence in a strong, calm voice.
School Words Steps	Desk strips, one per student.	"Point to each step and say it."	Each student says all four steps.
Color	Coloring page and crayons.	"Color Lee and Tee standing tall. Then say one school-word sentence."	A colored page and one please sentence.

Answer keys

- **Sort, School words:** Tee tells Diego, "Please go behind me" · Lee asks Kiara to give the marker back · Lee tells her teacher · Lee tells Malik, "Stop. That's not kind."
- **Sort, Not school words:** Diego laughs at a fallen tower · Kiara shouts at Diego · Malik laughs at Lee's drawing · Sofia grabs a marker back.
- **Put It in Order:** 1 Diego cuts in front of Tee · 2 Tee stands tall · 3 Tee says, "Diego, please go behind me" · 4 Diego says, "Oh, sorry!"

The mini book (one child, Tier 2)

- For a child who yells, calls names, or grabs back when someone cuts, takes, or teases. Read it one-on-one at a calm time, before the hardest part of the day.
- Read it every day for a week. Practice standing tall and saying each sentence in a strong, calm voice.
- Never read it as a consequence or right after an incident.
- On the back, the child colors a star each day they use strong, kind school words. Celebrate every star.

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When a student uses hurtful words

Follows the Responsive Behavior Plan: the adult response is the intervention. Fewer words as escalation rises.

1. **Stay calm.** Do not repeat the word or react to it. A big reaction teaches that the word is powerful.
2. **Fewer words.** "You are mad. Breathe with me. Stand tall." Do not lecture in the moment.
3. **Give the school words.** Ask, "What happened?" Then hand them the sentence: "Say, 'Diego, please go behind me.'"
4. **Step in when it keeps happening.** When a child tells you they used school words and it did not stop, act on it right away. That is how they learn grown-ups help.
5. **Repair later.** When everyone is calm, use Topic 6, Fixing It: "How did your friend feel? How can we make it right?" Then start fresh.

Next in the toolkit: Topic 11, Right-Size Voice.

Family connection

- Send the family half-sheet home the day you teach. It is in English, Spanish, and Haitian Creole.

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